

Canadian History





About the Course

Read about Canadian history from 1800-1900 through books that immerse students in the time period and allow them to see the world through the eyes of those who lived it. Through engaging narratives, biographies, history spines, primary source documents, oral histories, historical fiction, and books that show different perspectives, students come to see history as more than dates and events and develop relationships with people from the past. Viewing images, looking at maps, and working on one's Book of Centuries are also part of developing this relationship.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 7-8 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

Canadian history may be suitable for grade 9 students if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	Canadian History: Grades 7-8 2 times/week 30 min	The Story of Canada Elijah of Buxton The Charlottetown Conference and the Birth of Confederation Jeremy's War 1812 Sophie's Rebellion

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 7-8 (Canada)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 Canadian History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 Canadian History: Grades 7-8	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

☐ Parents and teachers may wish to pre-read chapters 21-22 of Elijah of Buxton, where there is a description of a group of slaves who have been captured by slave-catchers, and one has been murdered.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Canadian History: Grades 7-8



The Story of Canada



Elijah of Buxton



The Charlottetown Conference and the Birth of Confederation



Jeremy's War 1812



Sophie's Rebellion



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [History Charts & Timelines Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 7 Canadian History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 8 Canadian History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Canadian History: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any necessary links.
- If you have not read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.
- Decide which lessons/books to read together and which to have students read independently.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Have students give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, teachers may ask a leading question: "What can you tell me about..." Or students may try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson (often included in lesson plans).
- If necessary, talk about a few unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently. Sometimes reading for the specified time is a better guide.
- If a book is challenging, try stopping to narrate every now and then rather than waiting until the end. It can also help to read aloud. Or you might want to use an audiobook version of the text and have students read along with it.
- Have students keep an eye out for events or characters to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, or Copywork Book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or write a narration.
- Alternatively, students might analyze a character, trace cause to consequence, outline a passage, or use one of the other methods indicated by Charlotte Mason in School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Students who enjoy writing can experiment with different types of written narrations, but this is not required.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made (orally or in writing).

- You could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question to stimulate discussion. Discussion questions are often included in the lesson plans.



Connect

- Optional: Add something to the Book of Centuries, Century Chart, Citizenship Notebook, or Commonplace book. If students would like to include pictures, these may be drawn or printed.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Introduction - The War of 1812

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ INTRO

Throughout much of the eighteenth century and into the second decade of the nineteenth century, the British Navy was engaged in near-continuous naval conflicts until peace was declared in 1815, after the Battle of Waterloo. One of Britain's last major battles before then was the War of 1812, in which Canada, then still a collection of British colonies, became the battleground for a conflict between the United States and Britain over many long-standing grievances, including shipping rights and American expansionist plans.

The first historical novel we will read in this course is Jeremy's War 1812, a gripping account of the war told from the perspective of a fifteen-year-old orphaned boy who joins a regiment of British soldiers and eventually becomes the personal servant of Sir Isaac Brock. Historical details blend smoothly with a fictional story to create a detailed recreation of this definitive period in Canada's pre-Confederation history.

→ VIEW

The following video gives some background on the stakes for Canada in the War of 1812 and its importance for Canada's history.

∞ Video Link: The War of 1812 | The Canadian Perspective

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-18 "They were expecting me" - "and walked inside."

- Who are the characters you meet as the novel opens? How are they related to each other? What are they like? You may choose to keep a character list with some notes.

WEEK 1 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

The War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What did you learn about the characters of Jeremy and his uncle from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-32 "We were in a storeroom" - "continued down the road."

- What do you think of the choices Jeremy makes in this chapter? What would you have done in his place? What are you learning about his character and what it was like to be a teenager in the nineteenth century?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content, p.32: Parents and teachers may wish to explain that the word "rape" can also mean to snatch or take something by force; from the Latin rapio, which also gives us the English word "raptor."

WEEK 2 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

The War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

Take a moment to recall Jeremy's situation at the end of the last reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-46 "It was hard to sleep" - "have General Brock."

- Explain the causes of the War of 1812 as they are presented in today's reading. What makes Captain Stanton hopeful for success?



Term 1

→ VIEW

Take a few minutes to look at this map of York, now Toronto, made in 1813. In today's reading, Jeremy travels south on Yonge St. (most likely the sole road on this map that stretches north through the forest). Notice in the "Remark" on the map, that bridges over the Don River to the east of York were "decaying fast" and "in so great danger of falling that it was thought requisite at this time (Nov. 1813) to support." While the bridge that collapsed under Jeremy was north rather than east of York, this map shows that at this time, bridges could be hazardous for travellers.
∞ Map Link: 1813 Sketch of York

WEEK 2 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

The War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall of Jeremy's introduction to the 41st regiment from the last reading? You may want to refer back to the 1813 map of York as you read about the regiment's march towards the city.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.46-58 "Brock. I'd heard the name" - "I wondered what he knew."

- What do you think of Jeremy's decision? What do you think life will be like for him in the army?

WEEK 3 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

The War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

How did Jeremy describe the town of York and the garrison in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.59-71 "Mostly I remember" - "me to follow."

- What more do we learn about Jeremy's character from today's reading? How do you think he will fare as a batman? Why was he chosen?

→ VIEW

Learn more through reenactments about the rations served to soldiers in the War of 1812 and the Brown Bess musket Jeremy learns to use in today's reading:

∞ Video Link: Food in the War of 1812

∞ Video Link: The Brown Bess Musket in the War of 1812

WEEK 3 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

The War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-83 "We were in a hallway" - "I kept my mouth shut."

- What are your first impressions of General Brock? Continue to add to your character list.

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ VIEW

Over the course of the term, you will spend some time looking at the War of 1812 from four separate perspectives: the British, the American, the Canadian, and the Native American. Today, spend some time exploring the resources explaining the War of 1812 from the British perspective. Make some notes of what interests you.
∞ Link: The British War | 1812 Virtual Exhibition

WEEK 4 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

The War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall about General Brock from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-98 "It was a grey morning" - "on our way to war."

- What do you think of the General's plan? Study the map below to see just how far apart the two fronts are.

→ VIEW

∞ Map Link: 1812 Map - Control of the Lakes

WEEK 4 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

The War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812; map or atlas of Ontario

→ RECAP

What do you recall about General Brock's plan from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.99-113 "We sailed through the night" - "if the Americans are eager to fight?"

- What did you learn in today's reading about some of the logistics and preparations required for a major battle? What were some of the obstacles to General Brock's preparations? Why did nearly a third of the new recruits need to be sent back to their farms?

→ MAP WORK

Using a map or atlas of Ontario, locate Ancaster. Approximately how far would a march have been from where the troops disembarked at Burlington Bay?

→ VIEW

Today, spend some time exploring the resources explaining the War of 1812 from the American perspective. Make some notes of what interests you. Continue exploring these resources in future lessons.
∞ Link: The American War | 1812 Virtual Exhibition

★ TEACHER TIP

As you read today, continue to reference the map from the last lesson to plot the army's movement.

If you would like to map the major locations of the novel, you can do so on a blank map of the Great Lakes.

∞ Map Link: Blank Great Lakes Map

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: there is a propaganda print illustrating the scalping of American soldiers under the "Getting into War" section that some students may wish to skip.

WEEK 5 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

The War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812; map or atlas of Ontario

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the journey from Burlington Bay to Lake Erie from the last reading?

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-127 "The next day was still cloudy" - "Then came the betrayal."

- What are your first impressions of Tecumseh? Continue to add to and update your character list.

→ VIEW

No portrait of Tecumseh exists from his lifetime, but this painting is thought to have been made from a sketch of an even earlier (now lost) sketch of the Shawnee chief. What do you notice about this portrait? Do you think the author had this portrait in mind when he wrote his description?

∞ Image Link: Portrait of Tecumseh

WEEK 5 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

The War of 1812, cont.

📄 Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the first meeting between Brock and Tecumseh from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-140 "I was laying out Brock's clothes" - "They've surrendered!"

- Did the Battle of Fort Detroit turn out the way you expected? What surprised you in today's reading?

→ VIEW

Today, spend some time exploring the resources explaining the War of 1812 from the Native American perspective. Make some notes of what interests you. Continue exploring these resources in future lessons.

∞ Link: The Native American War | 1812 Virtual Exhibition

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch a dramatic reenactment of the Siege of Detroit from Canada, A People's History.

∞ Video Link: The Detroit Bluff
Watch from 1:06:45-1:13:11

WEEK 6 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

War of 1812, cont.

📄 Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the Surrender of Detroit from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.141-157 "Once again we were marching" - "understand the world."

- A lot happens in today's reading. How did your view of the characters change? How has Jeremy's personal experience of losing his farm shaped his understanding of the land rights of Tecumseh and his people?

→ VIEW

Learn more about the involvement of Indigenous peoples in the War of 1812.

∞ Video Link: Indigenous Peoples and the War of 1812

WEEK 6 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

War of 1812, cont.

📄 Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.158-171 "Why don't they attack" - "The Americans had attacked."

- What has happened in the weeks since the Siege of Detroit?

→ VIEW

The action in the novel has now moved to the Niagara front. As you read, consult the map below to locate the various forts and battle sites.

∞ Map Link: War of 1812 Map

WEEK 7 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

War of 1812, cont.

📄 Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.172-183 "I ran out of the barracks" - "Brock was dead."

→ WATCH & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: The Battle of Queenston Heights (October 1812)

- How many actual historical details from the battle does the author include in today's reading about Queenston Heights?

→ VIEW

Today, spend some time exploring the resources explaining the War of 1812 from the Native American perspective. Make some notes of what interests you. Continue exploring these resources in future lessons.

∞ Link: The Canadian War | 1812 Virtual Exhibition

WEEK 7 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

The War of 1812

📄 Materials: The Story of Canada

→ INTRO

Now that we've learned the fate of General Brock, we will pause from reading Jeremy's War for a lesson and read a historical overview of the War of 1812. If you have any extra time at the end of the lesson, you can continue to explore the 1812 Virtual Exhibition.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.78-81 "Britain and the United States" - "British North America would stay British."

p.92 and 94 (skip page 93) "A few years later" - "into the North."

→ VIEW

1. Spend some time looking at this engraving of The Battle of Queenston Heights. The original engraving this one is based on is attributed to Captain James Dennis, who fought in the battle. The Americans (in blue) are crossing the Niagara River to Queenston (the right side) from Lewiston (the left side).

∞ Image Link: The Battle of Queenston Heights

2. Visit Brock's Monument at Queenston Heights. You don't need to watch the whole video, but the drone footage provides an amazing view!

∞ Video Link: Canada's Most Imposing War Memorial

• IMPORTANT DATES

Tecumseh (1768-1813)

Sir Isaac Brock (1769-1812)

War of 1812 (1812)

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch a Heritage Minute about how the Grand River warriors helped to defeat the Americans at Queenston Heights after the death of General Brock.

∞ Video Link: Heritage Minutes: Queenston Heights



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WEEK 8 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Jeremy's experience of the Battle of Queenston Heights?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.184-197 "We carried his body" - "I closed the door softly behind me."

- Today's reading is the most violent in the whole book. How has Jeremy's experience changed him?

WEEK 8 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

War of 1812, cont.

Materials: Jeremy's War 1812

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading about the outcome of the Battle of Queenston Heights?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.197-207 "The next morning" - "book in your hands."

- What do you think of the ending of the novel? How has Jeremy changed over the past twenty years? How does he remember Brock at the War? What do you think of the novel as a whole? Do you think historical fiction is a good way to learn about major events in history?

→ VIEW

If you have any extra time at the end of the lesson, you can continue to explore the 1812 Virtual Exhibition.

WEEK 9 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

The Métis & The Red River Settlement

Materials: The Story of Canada; map or atlas of Canada that includes Manitoba

→ INTRO

While the War of 1812 was at its height in Upper and Lower Canada to the east, a Scottish nobleman named Thomas Douglas, 5th Earl of Selkirk, was working to establish a colony on the prairies to the west, at the intersection of the Red and Assiniboine Rivers, near what is now Winnipeg. Selkirk had received a large grant of land from the Hudson Bay Company and wanted to create a farming community to support many poor Scottish Highlanders and Irish peasants, who had lost their homes and livelihoods due to various upheavals at the end of the eighteenth century. This community, known as the Red River Settlement, would come to play a large role in the history of immigrants to the prairies, the Métis peoples, the province of Manitoba, and the history of Canada as a nation.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.114-120 "In April 1806" - "cries of despair."

→ MAPPING ACTIVITY

Look at a map or atlas of Manitoba (online is fine) and locate the Red River and Fort Douglas (present-day Winnipeg). Find the Hudson Bay on the same map so you can see the route the settlers took.

• IMPORTANT DATES

First settlers arrive at the Selkirk settlement in Red River (1811)

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Compare this modern map to a map of the land given to Selkirk:
∞ Map Link: Map showing the Selkirk Land Grant in 1811

→ VIEW

Learn more about elements of Métis culture, several of which are mentioned in today's reading: Métis sash, Red River cart, Red River jig, Métis flag, cuisine, beadwork, and fiddle. Follow the "Learn More" links under each heading.
∞ Link: Symbols of Métis Culture

WEEK 9 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18 *Immigration to Canada*

Materials: The Story of Canada

→ INTRO

What do you know about your own family's history in Canada? Where did your ancestors come from? Where did they settle? Where in Canada do you live now?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-89 "Grosse Ile is a beautiful island" - "their home was destroyed."

• EXTRA HELPING

Read excerpts from letters Catharine Parr Traill sent to her mother detailing her first impressions of Canada in 1832.
∞ Link: From Catharine Parr Traill, *The Backwoods of Canada*

WEEK 10 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19 *Rebellion and Reform*

Materials: The Story of Canada

→ RECAP

What did you read about immigration to Canada in the early nineteenth century?

→ INTRO

How do we choose our government in Canada and in our provinces and territories? Do you think it has always been this way in Canada? Today, we will learn about frustrations towards the government in the 1830s, which would eventually lead to the form of government we recognize today.

→ VIEW

Remember that in 1791, the large Province of Quebec was divided into Upper and Lower Canada, roughly corresponding to the provinces of Ontario and Quebec today.
∞ Link: Upper & Lower Canada in 1791

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93 "Bytown and Ottawa"

p.94-97 "In the 1830s" - "disguised in women's clothing"

• What changes did William Lyon Mackenzie want to see in Upper Canada?

• EXTRA HELPING

View more artwork by Cornelius Krieghoff.
∞ Image Link: Cornelius Krieghoff at the National Gallery of Canada

• IMPORTANT DATES

Louis-Joseph Papineau (1786-1871)
William Lyon Mackenzie (1795-1861)
Rebellions in Upper and Lower Canada (1836-1837)

WEEK 10 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20 *Sophie's Rebellion*

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the last reading about the discontent and rebellions in Lower Canada (now Quebec)?

→ INTRO

Sophie's Rebellion is a fictional account of one American girl's experience

• EXTRA HELPING

Students who would like extra background on the Patriote Rebellion against Lower Canada Loyalists are encouraged to watch this video. While the narration is in French, the auto-translated English subtitles are very accurate.
∞ Video Link: Patriot Rebellions in Quebec (1837-1838)



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of the 1837-1838 Rebellions, as she is caught up in the Battle of Beauharnois. Through Sophie's eyes, the reader is able to see multiple perspectives of this conflict and is introduced to a number of notable historical figures. The novel also provides an authentically detailed account of Upper and Lower Canada in the mid-nineteenth century.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-23 "The Rebellion of 1838" - "to have them."

- The book opens with a mysterious character named Luc. What do you know about him, and what questions do you still have?
- Who are the characters you meet as the novel opens? How are they related to each other? What are they like? What historical events have they been involved in, and where do their loyalties lie? You may choose to keep a character list with some notes.

→ VIEW

Look at the map below to see just how close Burlington, VT and Lake Champlain are to the Canadian border and Montreal.

∞ Map Link: Vermont & Quebec Map

WEEK 11 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the beginning of the novel you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.24-39 "Despite Sophie's apprehensions" - "before the day's over."

- What is Sophie's relationship like with the rest of her family? Why do you think her cousins treat her so poorly?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content, p.31 (repeated on p.33 and 36): please preview this argument between the children that refers to women using a derogatory term.

WEEK 11 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you remember from what you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.40-56 "That night the house" - "In your dreams."

→ VIEW

Spend some time looking at the following ten watercolour paintings the real Jane Ellice made during her trip to Beauharnois. If you click on each image, there is a description of what it depicts, and a number of these scenes are included in the novel.

∞ Image Link: Katherine Jane Ellice

WEEK 12 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Jeremy's War 1812

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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WEEK 12 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Story of Canada



Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you remember from what you read last time about Sophie's journey to Beauharnois?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.57-70 "When Sophie woke" - "shattered into worrying bits."

- What clues can you find in this reading about what life was like in Lower Canada in the 1830s? What are you learning about the different characters and their attitudes? Continue to add descriptions and information to your list of characters.

WEEK 1 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What impression did you get of Jane Ellice from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-85 "After tossing and turning" - "walking towards the manor house."

- What are the different characters' reactions when Beauharnois is attacked? How do they respond to this fear - what are their actions or thoughts?

WEEK 2 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the previous reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.85-100 "Or so she thought" - "the manor house."

→ READ

Joson Dumouchel and Toussaint Rochon from today's reading were both real people who, as punishment for the rebellion, were exiled to Australia. You can read more about these deportations in the article below and see the French Canadian monument at Bayview Park in Canada Bay, Australia.

∞ Article Link: The French Canadian Exiles of 1840

WEEK 2 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading of how Luc plans to keep Sophie safe?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.100-114 "Once they were back" - "understands the danger he's in."

• EXTRA HELPING

Learn more about the Frères-Chasseurs in Lower Canada and the Hunters' Lodges in the United States, who both worked towards removing all British rule in North America.

∞ Article Link: Association des Frères-Chasseurs

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- Why do you think the rebels would attack the steamship? How is Sophie beginning to feel caught between two sides of the conflict?

WEEK 3 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.115-129 "At Tuesday's breakfast" - "quietly by the fire."

- Can you explain the grievances of the Patriotes in your own words, after reading Luc's explanation to Sophie? How much of the eighteenth- and nineteenth-century North American history were you already familiar with?

WEEK 3 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

Where did the action leave off in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.129-145 "Sophie broke the silence" - "a twenty-man escort."

- What are some of the different ways the prisoners in the presbytery are acting under the stress of the situation? What do you think will happen?

→ VIEW

If you have time, today would be a good day to go back and look at some of Jane Ellice's watercolour paintings.

WEEK 4 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What had Sophie just learned at the end of the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.145-160 "Sophie felt more bewildered" - "very unpleasant around here."

- Sophie and Lady Theo helped Luc, even though it could mean breaking the law. What do you think of this choice? Why do you think Lady Theo declared, once the rebellion had been stopped, that "things are going to become very unpleasant around here?"

WEEK 4 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Sophie's Rebellion

Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.161-177 "Unpleasant vastly understated" - "down to the wharf."

- How have some of the characters changed since the beginning of the novel?

WEEK 5 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Sophie's Rebellion

📄 Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.177-189 "To Sophie's surprise" - "That way she could hide."

- Their ordeal in Beauharnois is over, but how has Sophie and Lady Theo's situation become more complicated?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the sensitive content on p.189.

WEEK 5 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Sophie's Rebellion

📄 Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.190-205 "To Sophie's great surprise" - "was Mrs. Bates."

- What do you think will happen next? How will the story end?

→ VIEW

This painting by Robert Auchmuty Sproule (1799-1845) is of the exact location where Sophie and Luc meet in the novel.

∞ Image Link: Nelson's Column and Notre Dame Street in 1830

WEEK 6 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Sophie's Rebellion

📄 Materials: Sophie's Rebellion

→ RECAP

What did Sophie learn from Luc in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.206-224 "'You!' Sophie stammered." - "whatever it took."

- Not all the action is resolved by the end of the novel, as there are two sequels: Sophie's Treason and Sophie's Exile. But what did you think of this novel? How well did the novel depict Lower Canada in the 1830s, and how much did you learn about the Rebellions that you didn't know before you read it?

WEEK 6 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

British North America

📄 Materials: The Story of Canada

→ INTRO

In today's reading, we will learn about what happened after the Rebellions

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch two Heritage Minutes about the reforms that were brought about by the rebellions in the 1830s:

∞ **Video Link:** Heritage Minutes: Baldwin & LaFontaine (Parents may wish to preview this one for

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

and the establishment of Responsible Government, which is still in practice in Canada today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.97-103 "Again, British North America" - "might be possible?"

- How did the system of Responsible Government change the way British North America was governed?

younger students since it does dramatize a violent scene.)

∞ **Video Link:** Heritage Minutes: Responsible Government (Queen Victoria voices her approval of the reforms.)

The sailing ship Marco Polo met its fate in a storm off the coast of Cavendish, and its running aground was witnessed by a young L.M. Montgomery, who later wrote an essay about it for the Montreal Daily Witness (March 5, 1891). You can read her essay [here](#).

∞ **PDF Link:** The Wreck of the Marco Polo

WEEK 7 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 37

British North America at Mid-Century

📄 Materials: The Story of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from the last reading about Responsible Government?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.121-127 "After the closing" - "stepping forth into the west."

- How did life for Indigenous people in the West change in the mid-nineteenth century?

→ VIEW

In today's reading, you learned that Paul Kane's paintings "caused a sensation. No one back east had ever seen such images." Spend some time looking at more paintings by Kane.

∞ Image Link: Paul Kane: Key Works

∞ Image Link: Paul Kane at the National Gallery of Canada

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: parents may wish to preview the photograph on page 127 of the remains of a sailor from the Franklin expedition, preserved in the ice.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Paul Kane (1810–1871)

Arctic Expedition of Sir John Franklin and his crew (1845)

Queen Victoria chooses Ottawa as the capital city (1857)

WEEK 7 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 38

British Columbia and the Fraser River Gold Rush

📄 Materials: The Story of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading or the Paul Kane picture study?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.143-151 "After Mackenzie and Fraser" - "with new interest."

• IMPORTANT DATES

Sir James Douglas, first governor of British Columbia (1803-1877)

WEEK 8 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 39

Pre-Confederation Years

📄 Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ INTRO

You may have heard of Canada's "Fathers of Confederation" and that Charlottetown, PEI, is sometimes called the "Birthplace of Confederation," but what really happened in the 1860s that led to Canada becoming a country? The next book we will read, *The Charlottetown*

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Conference and the Birth of Confederation, is a detailed account of the historical factors, issues, political players, and conferences that eventually led to Canada's Confederation in 1867. The book brings this historical period to life with numerous photographs, paintings, archival documents, and other primary sources, so be sure to spend some of your lesson time looking at the photos.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-8 "Robert Harris was several" - "wait another eight years."

→ NOTEBOOK

This book gives you an excellent chance to practice note-taking and finding information for a Century Chart or Book of Centuries. Look for important figures and significant dates and add them to a note-keeping format of your own choosing.

WEEK 8 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 40

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ INTRO

The third historical fiction novel we will read this year is the story of eleven-year old Elijah, the first child born free in the town of Buxton, Ontario, a settlement of runaway slaves and free Black people that was a haven of safety and hope, especially in the years leading up to the Civil War.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.343-345 Read the Author's Note to get an introduction to the town of Buxton and the historical context for the novel.
2. p.1-17 "It was Sunday after church" - "lets you know you're wrong."

- Start a character chart and write short descriptions of the people mentioned. You will continue to add to this chart as you read through the novel.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The novel is written from Elijah's first-person perspective, in his own distinct colloquial dialect. The audiobook version, with excellent narration by Mirron Willis, is a good option for getting a sense of the patterns of Elijah's language.

WEEK 9 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 41

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.8-16 "When we look back in time" - "about the region's future."

- What are some of the more surprising facts you learned today that you didn't know?

→ NOTEBOOK

Remember to record information in whatever way works best for you. You can try different methods of note-taking.

WEEK 9 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 42

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of the book from what you read last week?

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.17-35 "Two days later" - "the fish I catch."

- What does it mean for Elijah to be called fra-gile? How has the Frederick Douglass story shaped how Elijah sees himself?

WEEK 10 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 43

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.16-23 "In the nineteenth century" - "solution to these problems."

• COMPOSITION

In a well-structured paragraph, describe several differences between life in the British North American colonies before 1867 and life today.

WEEK 10 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 44

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off in the story last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.35-52 "When I got done" - "one tenth of ten."

- What do the interactions between Elijah and the Preacher reveal about their characters?

WEEK 11 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 45

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.25-33 "On June 14, 1864" - "the situation as 'political deadlock.'"

- Who are the major figures involved in the Charlottetown Conference? Start to make a list of names and add biographical details as you read.

WEEK 11 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 46

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off in the story last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.53-71 "When I got done" - "Yes, sir."

- What questions do you have after today's reading? How does the first-person narration affect the reader's understanding of situations in the novel?

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 12  30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 47 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Sophie's Rebellion	
WEEK 12  30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Story of Canada The Charlottetown Conference	

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 49

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-43 "On issues such as" - "danger still lurked to the south."

- Continue to add information to your historical note-keeping and biographical lists.

WEEK 1 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 50

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off in the story before exam week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-92 "Ma'd put a rag on the plate" - "caint help but last forever."

- What was the source of the misunderstanding? Why did Mr. Travis react the way he did? What does "familiarity breeds contempt" mean?

→ VIEW

If you have time today, you can view a tour of the schoolhouse at Buxton.
∞ Video Link: Buxton School House Tour

WEEK 2 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 51

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-53 "In 1865" - "a presumed Fenian plot."

- What are some of the motives for Confederation? Can you name at least three?

WEEK 2 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 52

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What happened in the schoolroom in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93-112 "The on-and-off-again" - "it in the sling."

- Describe the character of Mr. Leroy. How is he both a friend and a teacher to Elijah? What lesson does he teach him about the power of

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

words? Since Elijah was born free, he is slowly learning about the horrors of slavery through those around him.

- What seems unsettling to you about the carnival?

WEEK 3 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 53

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ NOTE

We are skipping Chapter 3, which covers the discussions around a possible union of the Maritime provinces that occurred in the late 1850s and early 1860s. You are welcome to read this on your own.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.69-76 "Eight Canadian cabinet ministers" - "Rum was the preferred beverage."

- What are some of the significant events in Charlottetown's history?

WEEK 3 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 54

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

Where did we leave off in the carnival scene in the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-133 "All the sudden Jimmy" - "the less you say the better."

- Why do you think the Preacher took Elijah to the carnival? What happened in today's reading?

WEEK 4 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 55

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.76-87 "The visiting delegates" - "citizens and reporters lay vacant."

WEEK 4 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 56

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.134-153 "Me and the Preacher" - "but they never did show."

- How would you describe the character of the Preacher? What was his scheme, and what ended up happening?

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 5 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 57

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.87-97 "The conference to discuss" - "in English and French."

- What details or events stood out or surprised you the most in this account of the activities of the Conference?

WEEK 5 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 58

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.154-174 "It was early Saturday" - "twixt 'em to and fro."

- What does this episode teach Elijah about the dangers of slavery and escaping to freedom? What did you learn about Buxton from this reading?

WEEK 6 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 59

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.98-107 "When the party" - "up to the Maritimes."

- Describe the events of the Quebec Conference. Remember to keep adding information to your historical note-keeping and biographical lists.

WEEK 6 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 60

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.175-196 "Pa said, 'Morning'" - "Mrs. Jacob Poole."

- What are some ways Elijah is becoming less "fra-gile"?

WEEK 7 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 61

Pre-Confederation Years

Materials: The Charlottetown Conference

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your last reading?



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.107-117 "Confederation was a more controversial" - "destroyed by fire."

- What surprised you most in reading this book? How was the creation of Canada different from the creation of other countries you have read about?

WEEK 7 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 62

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.196-216 "Mrs. Holton stood there" - "brains scrambled like eggs."

- What do these episodes continue to teach Elijah about the dangers of slavery and escaping to freedom? What did you learn about the pasts of some of the people in Buxton from this reading?
- How does the setting of this scene, heading to a picnic on the beach, contrast with the content of the stories?

WEEK 8 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 63

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.216-237 "After 'bout a week" - "feeling good 'bout this."

- What do you think of Elijah's words for Mrs. Holton? How has he used what he knows about language to benefit others?
- Do you sense any foreshadowing of what is to come? What do you think of the Preacher's plan?

WEEK 8 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 64

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.238-258 "Time don't never go" - "back to Cooter's home."

- What do you think has happened with the Preacher?
- Why does Elijah react the way he does?

WEEK 9 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 65

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.258-278 "I walked towards the church" - "that weren't plain to me."

- What is Mr. Leroy's plan?
- What do you think of Elijah's decision to go along with him? Why do you think he chooses to help him? What does Mr. Leroy mean to Elijah?

WEEK 9 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 66

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.278-298 "Mr. Leroy kept his word" - "my head kept spinning anyway."

- How much does Elijah draw on all he has learned so far in the novel once he is alone in America?
- What has happened to the Preacher, and what does it mean for Elijah to see the horrors of slavery first-hand for the first time?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the sensitive content in chapters 21-22. Please see the "Planning & Prep" section above for detailed information.

WEEK 10 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 67

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.298-318 "She said, 'Boy!'" - "squeezed her baby."

- How does this interaction with the runaway slaves affect Elijah? What is his plan to free them? What do you think will happen?

WEEK 10 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 68

Elijah of Buxton

Materials: Elijah of Buxton

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.318-341 "After 'while she smiled" - "And Hope slept the whole way."

- Why won't anyone help Elijah?
- Why do you think the final chapter is called "The Revenge of Mr. Frederick Douglass!"?
- Why does he tell Mrs. Chloe a made-up story about his younger sister? How does this show he is no longer "fra-gile" and understands grown-up language?
- Reflect on the novel: What did you think of the story? How did the ending make you think or feel?

• EXTRA HELPING

Learn more about the history of Buxton and view some images.

∞ **Article Link:** The Ontario black history landmark you never knew about

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 11 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 69

Into the West

Materials: The Story of Canada

→ INTRO

We are skipping ahead since we read a book about Confederation, but feel free to read p.154-171 on your own.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.172-177 "The Métis of Red River" - "freedom they once had."

- What were some factors that led to the founding of the North-West Mounted Police?

WEEK 11 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 70

The Great Railway

Materials: The Story of Canada

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week about the North-West Mounted Police?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.177-185 "On the Pacific coast" - "great in enterprise."

- Why was a transcontinental railway so important, and what were some of the effects of its completion?

• EXTRA HELPING

Louis Riel was tried and hanged for high treason in 1885, but history has come to regard him as, instead, one of the fathers of Confederation - the father of Manitoba. In 2024, Manitoba formally acknowledged him as its first Premier.

∞ **Article Link:** Riel formally recognized as first Premier

Did you notice the young boy front and centre in the photograph of the last spike being hammered into the railway at Craigellachie, BC? Learn more about him.

∞ **Article Link:** The Kid in the Last Spike

John A. Macdonald's wife, Agnes, had a unique way of riding the train! See another photograph of her from 1887.

∞ **Article Link:** History Corner -1887- Lady Agnes Macdonald

View a promotional poster from 1885 advertising the railroad and farming opportunities on the prairies.

∞ **Image Link:** The Canadian Pacific Railway

WEEK 12 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Charlottetown Conference

Canadian History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

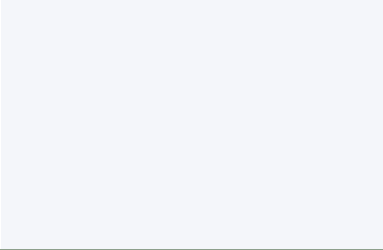
WEEK 12 30m Canadian History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Elijah of Buxton



Canadian History: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

- (Jeremy's War) Explain who Tecumseh was and his role in the War of 1812. OR Describe the events leading up to and the outcome of the Siege of Detroit, with particular attention to General Brock's decisions.
- (The Story of Canada) Describe Métis culture in the West: who are they, how did they live, and what was life like for them in the first decades of the nineteenth century? OR Explain why there was discontent in Upper and Lower Canada towards the government.

Term 2

- (Sophie's Rebellion) The novel features French Canadian, British, American, and English Canadian characters. Describe the attitudes and interactions of some of these groups towards each other, as depicted in the novel. OR Write a letter from Sophie to her father, describing all that happened in Beauharnois.
- (The Story of Canada and The Charlottetown Conference): Describe what life was like in Canada in the mid-nineteenth century, in the years leading up to Confederation. OR Explain how responsible government works.

Term 3

- (The Charlottetown Conference): Describe how the Charlottetown Conference and the meetings that came after led to the founding of Canada in 1867. OR Choose one prominent figure you learned about who attended the Charlottetown Conference, and explain why their contribution to Canada's history was important.
- (Elijah of Buxton): Describe the history of Buxton, including how it came to be, who lived there, what their homes, school, and other buildings were like, and why Buxton is important to learn about in Canadian History. OR Explain how Elijah changes from the beginning of the novel to the end. Why is he called "fragile" at first, and how does he eventually become the hero of the story?